Cambridge AS Level Islamic Studies (9488/12) — STRICT SYLLABUS REVISION NOTES

100% Aligned to the Official 9488 (2024–2026) Specification • Ordered Strictly by Oct/Nov 2026 Exam Predictions

HOW THESE NOTES ARE BUILT:
1. **Zero Off-Syllabus Fluff:** Every single section quotes the **exact official Cambridge** 9488 **syllabus bullet verbatim** so you never waste a minute revising outside what examiners mark.
2. **Ordered Strictly by Exam Probability:** Starts with the **never-tested Set Passages, Set Hadith, and untouched Section B units** (**Tier 1 Red-Hot**), followed by the **overdue repeats (**Tier 2**)**, and cuts out topics literally just tested in **May/June 2026** (*Q 10:99–100, Hadith 75, Qadar, and Death Rituals*).
3. **Built for Full Marks (**AO1 **+** AO2**):** Every topic gives you **(a) Complete Revision Notes + Key Arabic Terms + Scriptural Quotes (**AO1**)** AND **(b) Ready-Made Agree vs Counter-Arguments + Level 5 Conclusion Judgement (**AO2**)**.

PRIORITY NAVIGATION TABLE (READ IN THIS EXACT ORDER)

Order	Exam Section	Official Syllabus Unit	Predicted Topic	Past Paper Status (2021–June 2026)
1	**Section A (**Q1**)**	**1.2** Set Qurʾan	[PRIORITY #1] **Qurʾan 5:89–90** — Intoxicants & Deliberate Oaths	**NEVER TESTED IN 6 YEARS (#1)**
2	**Section A (**Q1**)**	**1.2** Set Qurʾan	[PRIORITY #1] **Qurʾan 4:12** — Inheritance (*Fara'id*)	**NEVER TESTED IN 6 YEARS (Co-#1)**
3	**Section A (**Q1**)**	**1.3** Set Hadith	[PRIORITY #1] **Hadith 54** — Truthfulness (*Sidq*)	**ONLY UNTESTED HADITH IN 6 YEARS (#1)**
4	**Section A (**Q1**)**	**1.2** & **1.3** Overdue	[HIGH PRIORITY] **Q 31:14–15**, **Q 13:3–4**, **Q 17:31–35** + **Hadiths 316, 309, 27, 199**	**Untested verses (**13:4**,** 17:31**) & 4–5 yr gaps**
5	**Section A (**Q1b**)**	**1.1** Prophet's Life	[SEERAH 1.1] **Strict Syllabus Notes on all 5 Sub-Bullets of Muhammad's (pbuh) Life**	**Tested inside EVERY** Q1(b) **[10 marks]**

Order	Exam Section	Official Syllabus Unit	Predicted Topic	Past Paper Status (2021–June 2026)
6	**Section B (Q2/Q3)**	**1.7** Faith in Action	[PRIORITY #1] **Rituals of** *Hajj* **& Equality in the** *Ummah* **+ Supporting Poor &** *Eid* **Sacrifices**	*Hajj* **rituals & equality NEVER TESTED**
7	**Section B (Q2/Q3)**	**1.5** Purification	[PRIORITY #1] **Purification for Prayer (***Wudu, Ghusl, Tayammum***),** *Niyyah*, *Shahadah*, *Sawm* **&** *Zakat*	**Prayer purification NEVER TESTED**
8	**Section B (Q2/Q3)**	**1.6** Devotion	[PRIORITY #1] *Ashura* **(10th Muharram: Sunni & Shiʾi), Personal** *Duʾa*, **Family &** *Nikah*	*Ashura* **& Role of Family NEVER TESTED**
9	**Section B (Q2/Q3)**	**1.4** Main Beliefs	[HIGH PRIORITY] **Angels (***Malaikah***),** *Tawhid*, **Books (***Wahy***), Prophets & Linking Beliefs to Pillars**	**Angels** (O/N 22) **&** *Tawhid* (M/J 22) **4+ yrs overdue**

PART 1: SECTION A REVISION NOTES — THE QURʾAN, HADITH & PROPHET (Q1 — 25 MARKS)

[PRIORITY #1] TOPIC 1: Qurʾan 5:89–90 — Oaths & Intoxicants (Syllabus 1.2 — #1 UNTESTED QURʾAN PASSAGE)

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.2**):**
• **5:89–90 Intoxicants** — *explain the teachings in these sources in relation to the Sunnah of Prophet Muhammad (pbuh); show how the teachings from these sources might be applied in the lives of Muslims today; discuss how the Prophet (pbuh) is a perfect example for Muslims to follow.*

[SET TEXT] Exact Specified Exam Text (*A. Yusuf Ali*)

> **5:89** *Allah will not call you to account for what is futile in your oaths, but He will call you to account for your deliberate oaths: for expiation, feed ten indigent persons, on a scale of the average for the food of your families; or clothe them; or give a slave his freedom. If that is beyond your means, fast for three days. That is the expiation for the oaths ye have sworn. But keep to your oaths. Thus doth Allah make clear to you His signs, that ye may be grateful.*
> **5:90** *O ye who believe! Intoxicants and gambling, (dedication of) stones, and (divination by) arrows, are an abomination,– of Satan's handwork: eschew such (abomination), that ye may prosper.*

[AO1 NOTES] Complete AO1 Revision Notes

- **Historical Context & Progressive Revelation (*Asbab al-Nuzul*):**
  - Revealed in **Medina** (*Surah Al-Ma'idah*, one of the last chapters revealed).
  - Pre-Islamic *Jahiliyyah* society was steeped in heavy wine-drinking (*khamr*), gambling debts (*maysir*), sacrificing on idol altars (*ansab*), and consulting fortune-telling arrows (*azlam*) at the *Ka'bah* before decisions or travel.
  - **Crucial Mark-Scheme Point — The 3 Stages of Prohibiting Alcohol:** Allah banned alcohol gradually out of wisdom so deeply ingrained habits could be broken:
  1. **Stage 1 (**Qur'an 2:219**):** Taught that wine and gambling contain *some benefit, but their sin/harm outweighs their benefit*.
  2. **Stage 2 (**Qur'an 4:43**):** Commanded believers **not to approach prayer (***salah***) while intoxicated** until knowing what they say.
  3. **Stage 3 (**Qur'an 5:90–91**): Total, permanent prohibition** after companions asked for a decisive ruling following quarrels at drinking gatherings; when proclaimed in Medina, companions immediately smashed their clay wine jars so wine flowed in the streets.
- **Verse** 5:89 **— Oaths (*Ayman*) & Expiation (*Kaffarah*):**
  1. **Unintentional / Futile Oaths (*Laghw*):** Casual slips of speech (*"No, by Allah!" / "Yes, by Allah!"* spoken automatically without intent to swear a binding vow) are **forgiven without punishment**, showing Allah's mercy and realism about human speech.
  2. **Deliberate / Solemn Oaths (*Al-Ayman al-Mu'aqqadah*):** Oaths sworn consciously using Allah's Name are binding covenants; Muslims are explicitly commanded **"keep to your oaths"** (*wahfazu aymanakum*) — **unless keeping an oath involves sin**, in which case the Prophet (pbuh) said: *"Whoever swears an oath and then sees something better should do what is better and expiate his oath"* [Muslim].
  3. **Exact Expiation (*Kaffarah al-Yamin*) for Breaking a Deliberate Oath:**
     - **Step 1 (Choice of 3 equal options first):**

  - Feed **10 poor people (***masakin***)** at the **average quality of food** one feeds one's own family *(prevents giving stale/inferior leftovers!)*; **OR**
  - Clothe **10 poor people**; **OR**
  - Free **1 enslaved person** *(encouraging emancipation in early society)*.
  - **Step 2 (Only if financially unable to do ANY of Step 1):**
  - **Fast for 3 days** *(shows Islam holds poor and rich equally accountable, while turning human failure into social charity)*.

4. **Purpose:** Clarifies Allah's signs (*ayat*) so believers cultivate **gratitude (***shukr***)**.

- **Verse** 5:90 **— Four Prohibited Abominations (***Rijs***):**
  1. **Intoxicants (***Khamr***):** Anything that clouds the intellect (*"Every intoxicant is khamr, and every khamr is haram"* — [Muslim]). Applied by analogy (*qiyas*) today to **illegal drugs, narcotics, and substance abuse**. Protects the **intellect (***hifz al-ʿaql***)**, family peace, health, and remembrance of Allah (**5:91**).
  2. **Gambling / Games of Chance (***Maysir***):** Acquiring others' wealth by luck without productive labour — breeds enmity, addiction, financial ruin, and hatred (**5:91**). Applied today to **casinos, lotteries, online sports betting, and speculative gambling**.
  3. **Dedication of Stones (***Ansab***):** Pagan stone altars around the *Kaʿbah* where animals were slaughtered for idols (**major** *shirk* violating *Tawhid*).
  4. **Divination by Arrows (***Azlam***):** Headless arrows marked *"Do" / "Do not" / blank* drawn by shrine custodians to claim knowledge of the unseen (*ghayb*) — replaced in Islam by **rational consultation (***shura***),** *Salat al-Istikharah***, and trust in Allah (***tawakkul***)**. Modern application: **horoscopes, tarot, fortune-telling, superstitions**.
  5. **Spiritual Diagnosis & Goal:** Labelled *rijs min ʿamal al-shaytan* (*impure abomination of Satan's handiwork*); believers must **shun (***ijtanibu***) even approaching them** (e.g. not sitting at alcohol tables, selling, or transporting intoxicants) in order to achieve **true prosperity (***falah***)** in this world and the hereafter.
- **Link to the Prophet's Sunnah (**1.1**):**
  - Even before prophethood in Mecca, Muhammad (pbuh) **never drank wine, gambled, swore by pagan idols (***Lat / Uzza***), or consulted arrows**.
  - On *Isra wal-Miʿraj*, Jibril offered him bowls of milk and wine; he chose **milk**, representing natural purity (*fitrah*).
  - Kept every solemn covenant, including the **Treaty of Hudaybiyyah** and returning Quraish trusts via ʿ**Ali (ra)** at the *Hijrah*.

[AO2 EVAL] Built-In AO2 Evaluation Notes (1(c) [10 Marks])

- **Likely** 1(c) **Debate Angles:** *(1) "Avoiding haram is more important than doing good deeds."* OR *(2) "Avoiding intoxicants and gambling is harder for Muslims today than in the past."*
  - **Agree Side:** Prophet's Hadith *"Avoid what I have forbidden completely; do what I have commanded as much as you are able"*; *haram* actively harms others (*huquq al-ʿibad* — drunk driving, gambling bankruptcy) and wipes out good deeds (*Hadith of the bankrupt person*); today 24/7 smartphone betting apps, workplace alcohol culture, and normalized interest/vice target youth privately.
  - **Disagree / Counter Side:** Passive avoidance alone omits the very purpose of creation (**worship, Q 51:56** & **Five Pillars, Hadith 73**); active prayer (**Q 29:45**) and fasting (**Q 2:183**) build the *taqwa* needed to resist *haram*, and good deeds erase minor sins (**Q 11:114**). Historically, early Companions lived in Meccan *Jahiliyyah* where wine and idols were the entire social economy, yet abandoned them instantaneously upon hearing **Q 5:90**.
  - **Level 5 Nuanced Conclusion:** Abstaining from grave *haram* takes precedence over **voluntary (*nafl*)** good deeds, while standing as an **inseparable partner alongside obligatory (*fard*) worship** to achieve complete *taqwa*.

[PRIORITY #1] TOPIC 2: Qurʾan 4:12 — Inheritance (*Mirath / Faraʾid*) (Syllabus 1.2 — CO-#1 UNTESTED PASSAGE)

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (1.2):**
• **4:12 Inheritance** — *teachings in relation to the Sunnah of Prophet Muhammad (pbuh); application in the lives of Muslims today; how the Prophet (pbuh) is a perfect example.*

[SET TEXT] Exact Specified Exam Text (*A. Yusuf Ali*)

4:12 *In what your wives leave, your share is a half, if they leave no child; but if they leave a child, ye get a fourth; after payment of legacies and debts. In what ye leave, their share is a fourth, if ye leave no child; but if ye leave a child, they get an eighth; after payment of legacies and debts. If the man or woman whose inheritance is in question, has left neither ascendants nor descendants, but has left a brother or a sister, each one of the two gets a sixth; but if more than two, they share in a third; after payment of legacies and debts; so that no loss is caused (to any one). Thus is it ordained by Allah; and Allah is All-knowing, Most Forbearing.*

[AO1 NOTES] Complete AO1 Revision Notes

- **Historical Context (*Asbab al-Nuzul*):**
  - Revealed in **Medina** (*Surah An-Nisa*), especially after battles like **Uhud (3 AH)** left many widows and orphans (e.g. the widow of **Saʿd ibn al-Rabiʿ**, whose deceased husband's brother seized the entire estate leaving her and her two daughters destitute until the Prophet (pbuh) implemented divine shares!).
  - In pre-Islamic *Jahiliyyah*, **only adult male warriors** (*"those who ride horses and wield swords"*) inherited wealth; **wives, mothers, daughters, and young orphans inherited zero**—and widows themselves were sometimes inherited as chattel!
- **Exact Share Table inside** Qurʾan 4:12 **(MEMORISE COLD — Guaranteed** 5/5 **in** 1(a)**!):**

Surviving Heir	Condition	Exact Fixed Share	Notes
Husband (from deceased wife)	Wife leaves **NO child** (*farʿ warith*)	**1/2** (Half)	Reduced when children exist so children get primary support
Husband (from deceased wife)	Wife **leaves a child**	**1/4** (Fourth)	Applies whether child is from him or prior marriage
Wife (from deceased husband)	Husband leaves **NO child**	**1/4** (Fourth)	Shared equally if polygyny
Wife (from deceased husband)	Husband **leaves a child**	**1/8** (Eighth)	Plus her *mahr* and personal property remain 100% hers!
Kalalah **Case — Maternal Sibling**	Deceased leaves **NO parents (ascendants) & NO children (descendants)**, leaving **1 brother OR 1 sister**	**1/6** (Sixth) EACH — EQUAL FOR MALE & FEMALE!	**Crucial nuance for AO2:** Male and female get the **EXACT SAME** 1/6 **or share** 1/3 **equally** here!
Kalalah **Case — Multiple Maternal Siblings**	Deceased leaves **NO parents & NO children**, leaving **more than two siblings**	**Share** 1/3 **(Third) equally**	Protects wider kin when nuclear line is absent

- **Three Mandatory Pre-Distribution Rules Repeated Three Times in** 4:12**:**
  1. **Funeral expenses & Debts (*Dayn*) paid FIRST** — creditors' rights (*huquq al-ʿibad*) take priority; Prophet (pbuh) stressed settling a deceased believer's debts immediately.

2. **Legacies / Bequests (*Wasiyyah*) paid SECOND** — capped by the Prophet's Sunnah (**Saʿd ibn Abi Waqqas Hadith**) at **maximum** 1/3 **of the estate** (*"A third, and even a third is much; leaving heirs wealthy is better than leaving them begging"*) and **not to an existing fixed heir** so family shares aren't rigged. *(Allows Muslims today to leave up to 1/3 to non-Muslim relatives, adopted children, or mosques/charities!)*
3. **"So that no loss/harm is caused to anyone" (*ghayra mudarr*):** Forbids fabricating fake debts or unfair wills purely to deprive rightful female/orphan heirs.

- **Divine Authority Closing** 4:12**:** Ordained directly by **Allah (**Fariḍatan min Allah**)**, who is **All-Knowing (*ʿAlim*)** of true family needs across generations and **Most Forbearing (*Halim*)**, warning believers not to Delay or manipulate shares.
- **Link to the Prophet's Sunnah (**1.1**):**
  - Enforced Saʿd ibn al-Rabiʿ's widow's and daughters' shares immediately; left zero personal inheritance for his own family (*"We prophets are not inherited from; what we leave is charity"*), living simply while championing women's independent ownership (**Khadijah**), orphans' property (**Qurʾan 17:34**), and mothers' supreme honour (**Hadith 316**).

[AO2 EVAL] Built-In AO2 **Evaluation Notes (**1(c) **[10 Marks])**

- **Likely** 1(c) **Debate Angle:** *"Islamic rules on inheritance / treatment of women's wealth are completely fair in the modern world."*
  - **Agree Side:** Granted women permanent, divinely protected property rights **1,200+ years before Western Married Women's Property Acts**; men receive double share in spousal/child cases **ONLY because Shariah imposes 100% legal financial obligation (*nafaqah* — housing, food, clothing, healthcare, plus marriage *mahr*) on men**, whereas a Muslim woman keeps **100% of her inheritance, *mahr*, and income for herself with zero legal obligation to spend a penny on household bills**; maternal siblings in **4:12** inherit **identically (**1/6**)** proving gender is NOT degraded, rather shares track financial duty; **1/3 wasiyyah** gives practical modern flexibility.
  - **Counter Side:** In modern dual-income economies or where brothers/husbands neglect their Islamic duty of *nafaqah* after taking double shares, divorced/single women may support entire households while receiving half the share; cultural abuse (*pressuring sisters to "forgive" their land shares*) violates **4:12** directly.
  - **Level 5 Nuanced Conclusion:** The divine formula in **4:12** is **holistically equitable when applied alongside mandatory male maintenance (*nafaqah*) and** *mahr*; perceived unfairness today stems primarily from **selective practice**—men claiming their *Qurʾanic* share while abandoning their *Qurʾanic* financial duties toward female kin.

[PRIORITY #1] TOPIC 3: Hadith 54 **— Truthfulness (*Sidq*) (**Syllabus 1.3 **— ONLY UNTESTED HADITH IN 6 YEARS!)**

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.3**):**
• **54 Truthfulness** — *explain themes in relation to the Sunnah of Prophet Muhammad (pbuh); application in Muslims' lives today; how the Prophet (pbuh) is a perfect example.*

[SET TEXT] Exact Specified Exam Text (*Riyad as-Salihin, Book 1, Hadith 54*)

Abdullah bin Masʿud (May Allah be pleased with him) reported: The Prophet (pbuh) said, "Truth leads to piety and piety leads to Jannah. A man persists in speaking the truth till he is enrolled with Allah as a truthful. Falsehood leads to vice and vice leads to the Fire (Hell), and a person persists on telling lies until he is enrolled as a liar." [Al-Bukhari and Muslim].

[AO1 NOTES] Complete AO1 Revision Notes

- **Two Opposite Spiritual Chains Taught in** Hadith 54**:**
  1. **Upward Chain: Truthfulness (***Sidq***)** in word, intention, and deed -> cultivates **Righteousness / Piety (***Al-Birr* **— comprehensive goodness)** -> leads to **Paradise (***Jannah***)**; continuous effort (*taharri al-sidq*) until written in Allah's Divine Sight as a *Siddiq (highest rank directly beneath Prophets — Qurʾan 4:69, exemplified by Abu Bakr As-Siddiq!)*.
  2. **Downward Chain: Falsehood (***Al-Kadhib***)** -> breeds **Wickedness / Immorality (***Al-Fujur***)** because one lie requires sins and cover-ups -> drags to **Hellfire (***Jahannam***)**; persistence records the person with Allah as a **habitual liar (***kadhdhab***)**.
- **Cross-References to Pair Automatically in** Q1(b) *(Mandatory Second Text Rule!)***:**
  - **Hadith 199** (Hypocrites): *"Three signs of a hypocrite: when he speaks, he lies; when he promises, he breaks it; when trusted, he betrays trust."* **[Bukhari & Muslim].**
  - **Qurʾan 33:70** / **9:119**: *"O you who believe! Fear Allah and be with those who are truthful (***al-sadiqin***)."*
  - **Qurʾan 17:35**: **Honest full measure and straight balance in business.**
- **Concrete Examples from Prophet Muhammad's (pbuh) Life (**1.1**):**
  1. **Meccan Title** *As-Sadiq* **&** *Al-Amin***:** Trusted banker for Meccans; on **Mount Safa**, even Abu Jahl/Quraish confessed: *"We have never experienced a single lie from you."* Also testified by Abu Sufyan in **Heraclius's Roman court**!
  2. **Night of** *Hijrah* **(622 CE):** Left **ʿAli (ra)** in Mecca at risk of life to return every trust/valuables to hostile idolaters.
  3. **Business & Public Integrity:** Partnered honestly with **Khadijah** in Syria trade; inspected Medina market grain heap (*"Whoever cheats us is not one of us"*).

4. **Zero White Lies in Jokes or Parenting:** Joked truthfully without ever speaking falsehood; warned a mother calling her child for a date that failing to give it records a lie [Abu Dawud]. *(Only 3 narrow Sunnah exceptions for reconciling enemies, saving life in war, or healing marriage harmony — [Muslim].)*

[HIGH PRIORITY] TOPIC 4: TIER 2 OVERDUE & PARTIAL SET TEXTS (1.2 & 1.3 — 10-MINUTE HIGH-YIELD COVERAGE)

4.1 Qurʾan 31:14–15 — Parents (*Luqman*) + Hadith 316 — Mother Three Times *(Last seen: O/N 2021 — 5 yrs ago!)*

- **Verbatim Key Text (**31:14–15**):** Mother bore child *"in travail upon travail, and in years twain (2 years) was his weaning: Show gratitude to Me and to thy parents... But if they strive to make thee join in worship with Me things (*shirk*)... obey them not; yet bear them company in this life with justice and consideration..."*
- **Verbatim Key Text (**Hadith 316**):** *"Who among people is most deserving of my fine treatment?" — "Your mother" (x3) -> "Then your father."* [Bukhari & Muslim].
- **Key Revision Notes:**
  - Context of **31:15**: Revealed concerning **Saʿd ibn Abi Waqqas**, whose mother swore neither to eat nor drink in Mecca until he renounced Islam; Allah forbade obeying her demand for *shirk* while commanding him still to speak gently and care for her! Also **Asma bint Abi Bakr** hosted and gave gifts to her non-Muslim mother **Qutaylah** with the Prophet's approval.
  - Pair with **Qurʾan 17:23–24**: Honour parents right after worshipping Allah alone; never say even *"Uff"* in irritation; *"lower to them the wing of humility out of mercy."*
  - **Mother's Triple Honour (**Hadith 316**):** Scholars highlight three unique burdens carried solely by the mother — **pregnancy hardship, pain of childbirth, and two years of breastfeeding/sleepless care** (**Q 31:14**, **Q 46:15**).
  - **Prophet's Examples (**1.1**):** Wept tenderly visiting his mother **Aminah's** grave at Abwa; stood up and spread his own cloak (*rida'*) on the ground whenever his foster-mother **Halimah al-Saʿdiyyah** visited; called caregiver **Umm Ayman** *"my mother after my mother"*; sent a man back from *jihad* to care for his elderly parents (*"Strive in serving them"*).

4.2 Qurʾan 13:3–4 — Signs in Creation (*13:4 NEVER PRINTED BEFORE!*)

- **Verbatim Text of** 13:4 **(***Yusuf Ali***):** *"And in the earth are tracts (diverse though) neighbouring, and gardens of vines and fields sown with corn, and palm trees – growing out of single roots or otherwise: watered with the same water, yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Behold, verily in these things there are signs for those who understand!"*
- **Key Revision Notes (**5/5 **Points if** 13:3–4 **Prints!):**
  1. **13:3** points to macro-cosmic signs (*ayat*): outstretched habitable earth, immovable **mountains as stabilising pegs**, **flowing rivers**, **fruits created in pairs (male/female pollination)**, and **night veiling day** for human rest.
  2. **13:4** zooms in on botanical wonder: **side-by-side plots of soil** (*qitaʿun mutajawirat*) growing **grapes, grain fields, clustered date-palms (***sinwan***) and single-trunk palms (***ghayr sinwan***)**.
  3. **Crucial Miracle Argument:** All are **irrigated by the EXACT SAME ONE RAINWATER (***yusqa bi-maʾin wahid***)**, yet differ wildly in colour, aroma, nutrient value, and sweetness — proving intelligent design by **One Wise Creator (***Tawhid***)**, NOT blind chance!
  4. **Parable in Classical** *Tafsir* **(Ibn Kathir / Al-Tabari):** Commentators note **13:4** also symbolises **human hearts**: all receive the **same one Divine Revelation (Qurʾan)**, yet pure hearts bear sweet fruits of faith (*iman*) while hardened hearts remain barren!
  5. Calls humans explicitly to **rational reflection (***yatafakkarun* **/** *yaʿqilun***)**, linking nature's revival after rain directly to **bodily resurrection (**13:5**)**.

4.3 Qurʾan 17:31–35 — Children's Lives (17:31 Untested!), Chastity, Orphans & Honest Scales + Hadiths 309, 27, 199

- **17:31** (Untested!): *"Kill not your children for fear of want (***imlaq***): We shall provide sustenance (***rizq***) for them as well as for you. Verily the killing of them is a great sin (***khitʾan kabira***)."* **-> Abolished pre-Islamic female infanticide (***waʾd al-banat***); establishes** Allah (*Ar-Razzaq*) alone as Provider**; notice** *"for THEM first, then you"***! Relevant today to sanctity of infant/unborn life, child welfare, and trusting** *rizq***.**
- **17:34–35**: **Guard orphan's property strictly to invest/grow until maturity; keep every contract (***questioned on Day of Reckoning***); give** full measure and straight scales **in trade (**17:35**) -> best outcome in** *ʾakhirah***. Prophet himself grew up an orphan under** Abu Talib **& promised:** *"I and the guardian of an orphan will be in Jannah like these two fingers"* **[Bukhari].**
- **Hadith 309** (Neighbours & Guests): **Faith in Allah & Last Day requires** (1) kindness to neighbours **(Muslim & non-Muslim — Prophet shared broth with Jewish neighbour),** (2) hospitality to guests**,** (3) speaking good or keeping silent**.**

- **Hadith 27** (Perseverance): **Believer always wins —** prosperity -> gratitude (*shukr*) **= good;** adversity -> patience (*sabr*) **= good [Muslim]. Modelled in Meccan boycott,** *Ta'if***, and baby Ibrahim's passing.**

[SEERAH 1.1] TOPIC 5: STRICT SYLLABUS NOTES ON 1.1 THE LIFE OF PROPHET MUHAMMAD (PBUH)

(Covers all 5 official syllabus sub-bullets cleanly — your universal Q1(b) engine!)

1. **Bullet 1 — Early Years & First Proclamation to** 622 CE**:**
   - Born **570 CE** (Year of the Elephant) in Mecca; father ʿ**Abdullah** died before birth; nursed in desert by **Halimah al-Saʿdiyyah**; orphaned of mother **Aminah** at age 6, raised by grandfather ʿ**Abd al-Muttalib** then uncle **Abu Talib** (worked as shepherd & honest merchant).
   - Joined *Hilf al-Fudul* pact protecting oppressed strangers; married **Khadijah (ra)** at 25; resolved **Black Stone (***Hajar al-Aswad***)** dispute peacefully at 35 using a shared cloak.
   - Retreated for contemplation (*tahannuth*) in **Cave Hira** on *Jabal al-Nur*; **610 CE (**Laylat al-Qadr**, age 40)**: Angel **Jibril** revealed **Qurʾan 96:1–5** (*"Read in the Name of thy Lord who created..."*); comforted by **Khadijah** & **Waraqah ibn Nawfal**.
2. **Bullet 2 — Challenges to Meccan Beliefs (**610–622 CE**):**
   - Directly challenged Quraish **idolatry (***360 idols* **at Kaʿbah — attacking their prestige & pilgrimage revenues)**, **social arrogance/slavery** (elevating enslaved **Bilal** & **Sumayyah/Yasir**), **female infanticide**, **usury (***riba***)**, and **accountability after death**.
   - Endured mockery, physical abuse during prayer, **migrations to Christian Abyssinia (615 CE)** under just King **Negus (***Najashi***)**, **3-year economic & social boycott in** *Shiʾb Abi Talib*, **Year of Sorrow (**619 CE **— deaths of Khadijah & Abu Talib)**, and bleeding stone attack at *Taʾif* (where he forgave and prayed for their descendants), comforted by *Isra wal-Miʿraj* **(Night Journey & Ascension — gift of 5 daily** *Salah***)**, followed by **First & Second Pledges of** *ʿAqabah* with pilgrims from Yathrib.
3. **Bullet 3 — The** *Hijrah* **(**622 CE**) & Its Significance:**
   - Planned wisely yet trusted Allah: left ʿ**Ali (ra)** in his bed **to return Meccan deposits**, hid 3 days with **Abu Bakr** in **Cave Thawr** (**Q 9:40**), arrived at **Quba** (built Islam's first mosque).
   - **4 Key Significances:** (1) Marked birth of an **autonomous, multi-faith Islamic state (***Ummah***)** starting the Islamic lunar **Hijri calendar (**1 AH**)** under Umar's caliphate; (2) Shifted revelation from Meccan creed to **Medinan social/legal legislation**; (3) Paired every penniless Meccan migrant (*Muhajir*) in brotherhood (*muʾakhah*) with a Medinan helper (*Ansar*); (4) Proved religious loyalty transcends tribal blood ties.

4. **Bullet 4 — Administration & Leadership Roles in Medina (Religious, Political & Military):**
   - **Religious Leader:** Built **Masjid al-Nabawi** as worship, court, school (*Suffah*), and welfare hub; instituted *Adhan*, *Jumuʿah*, *Zakat*, *Sawm*, *Eid*, and explained Qurʾan through living *Sunnah*.
   - **Political Statesman:** Drafted the **Constitution / Charter of Medina** — united *Muhajirun*, *Ansar*, and Jewish tribes as one civic community with **religious freedom, mutual defence, and justice**; sent diplomatic letters to rulers (Heraclius, Khosrow, Negus, Muqawqis); signed strategic **Treaty of Hudaybiyyah (**6 AH**)** calling it a *"Clear Victory"* (**Q 48:1**).
   - **Ethical Military Commander:** Fought strictly in defence (**Q 22:39**): **Badr (**2 AH**)**, **Uhud (**3 AH **— consulted** *shura***, forgave archers)**, **Trench /** *Khandaq* **(**5 AH **— dug trench personally with Salman al-Farisi)**; enforced humane rules of war (*never harm women, children, elderly, monks, crops, or captives — Badr prisoners freed for teaching 10 Muslims to read!*); **Bloodless Conquest of Mecca (**8 AH / 630 CE**)** with humble prostration on camel and universal amnesty (*"Go, for you are free"*).
5. **Bullet 5 — Morals, Manners & Character as Example (***Uswah Hasanah* **—** Q 33:21 **&** Q 68:4**):**
   - ʿ**A'ishah (ra):** *"His character was the living Qurʾan"* [Muslim]; **Qurʾan 68:4:** *"Exalted standard of character."* Combined truthfulness, humility (sewed own clothes, sat on floor with poor), mercy to women/children/animals, forgiveness, and deep nightly devotion.

PART 2: SECTION B REVISION NOTES — BELIEFS, PRACTICES & CEREMONIES (Q2 OR Q3 — 25 MARKS)

REMEMBER: You only answer **ONE** question in Section B (**25 marks = 10 + 15**), and Cambridge pairs **one** 1.4 Beliefs **question** with **one** 1.5–1.7 Practices **question**. Master the **4 units below** and you are completely bulletproof!

[PRIORITY #1] SECTION B PREDICTION #1: Unit 1.7 Putting Faith into Action **(*Hajj Rituals & Equality, Charity, & Eid Sacrifices*)**

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.7**):**
- support for the poor through almsgiving (zakat), voluntary donations and charitable giving
- creation of equality in the Islamic community (ummah) through acts of devotion including the rituals of pilgrimage (Hajj)
- the inclusion of everyone in the Eid festivals; importance of sacrifices made for God and rewards shared in family and community
- the relationship between intentions, actions and belief in judgement and the afterlife.

[AO1 NOTES] 1.7A Complete Notes: Rituals of *Hajj* & How Each Ritual Creates Equality (#1 Predicted Q2(a)!)

- **Definition & Obligation:** Fifth Pillar of Islam; obligatory **once in a lifetime** between **8th–12th** *Dhul-Hijjah* in Mecca upon sane adult Muslims with physical and debt-free financial capability (*istitaʿah* — **Qurʾan 3:97**). Commemorates **Prophet Ibrahim, Hajar, and Ismaʾil (pbut)** and Prophet Muhammad's Farewell Pilgrimage (**10 AH**).
- **Chronological Step-by-Step Rituals + Exact Equality Meaning (Memorise All 7 Steps!):**
  1. **Intention (***Niyyah***) & Entering** *Ihram* **at the** *Miqat***:**
     - Perform *ghusl*, trim nails, cross boundary station (*miqat*). Men replace all tailored/luxury garments with **two plain, unstitched white cloths** (*izar* & *rida'*); women wear clean, modest plain dress with face uncovered; no perfume, hunting, arguing, or marital intimacy (**Q 2:197**).
     - **Equality Impact:** Instantly erases crowns, designer suits, uniforms, and social rank — presidents and street-sweepers dress identically like burial shrouds (*kafan*), reminding all of death and equal standing before Allah, chanting the same **Talbiyah**: *"Labbayk Allahumma Labbayk..."* (*"Here I am, O Allah, here I am"*).
  2. *Tawaf* **(Circumambulating the** *Kaʿbah* **7 Times Anti-Clockwise):**
     - Starting from the **Black Stone (***Hajar al-Aswad***)**, millions circle one central house built by Ibrahim & Ismaʾil.
     - **Equality Impact:** Every race, nationality, gender, and school (Sunni, Shiʾi, Sufi) moves in one concentric flow around one *Qiblah* with zero VIP lanes around Allah's House.
  3. *Saʿi* **(Walking/Hastening 7 Times Between** *Safa* **and** *Marwah***):**
     - Drinks **Zamzam** water (miraculously sprung beneath baby Ismaʾil's heels) and walks 7 times between hills *Safa* and *Marwah*.
     - **Equality Impact:** Every king, scholar, and man on earth **re-enacts the footsteps of Hajar—a black, formerly enslaved woman** whose *tawakkul* Allah immortalised forever (**Q 2:158**), shattering racial, class, and gender superiority!
  4. **Stay at** *Mina* **(**8th Dhul-Hijjah **—** *Yawm al-Tarwiyah***):**

- Pilgrims camp simply side by side in uniform tents, praying shortened prayers and preparing hearts.

5. **Standing on the Plain of** *ʿArafat* **(***Wuquf* **—** 9th Dhul-Hijjah**, Noon to Sunset):**
   - **The Pinnacle of** *Hajj***:** Prophet (pbuh) declared *"Hajj IS ʿArafat"* [Tirmidhi] — missing *ʿArafat* invalidates *Hajj*. Millions stand together under the open sky crying in *duʾa* and *istighfar* on *Jabal al-Rahmah*.
   - **Equality Impact:** Rehearses the **Day of Resurrection (***Yawm al-Qiyamah***)**; site of the **Farewell Sermon**: *"All mankind is from Adam and Hawwa; an Arab has no superiority over a non-Arab, nor white over black, except by taqwa!"*
6. **Night Under the Open Sky at** *Muzdalifah* **(**Night of 9th–10th**):**
   - Pray combined *Maghrib* & *Isha*, **sleep directly on the ground under open stars** with zero luxury hotels, and collect **pebbles** (49 or 70). Rich and poor share identical dust and sky.
7. **10th–12th** *Dhul-Hijjah* **—** *Rami***,** *Udhiyah* **Sacrifice,** *Halq/Taqsir* **&** *Tawaf al-Ifadah***:**
   - **10th (***Yawm al-Nahr* **/** *Eid ul-Adha***):** Stone the large pillar *Jamarat al-ʿAqabah* with 7 pebbles (recalling Ibrahim rejecting Satan's whispers to disobey Allah); slaughter **sacrificial animal (***Hady / Udhiyah***)** sharing meat with the poor worldwide; **shave (***halq***) or trim (***taqsir***) hair** symbolizing spiritual rebirth free of sins (*"returns as sinless as the day his mother bore him"* — Bukhari); return to Mecca for obligatory *Tawaf al-Ifadah*; stone all 3 pillars on 11th–12th (*Days of Tashriq*) & perform farewell *Tawaf al-Wadaʿ*.

[AO1 NOTES] 1.7B Supporting the Poor, Inclusion in *Eid* & Sacrifices + Intentions-Actions-Afterlife Link

- **Three Tiers of Supporting the Poor (**1.7 **Bullet 1):**
  1. **Obligatory** *Zakat***: 2.5%** annual wealth transfer above *nisab* threshold held for 1 lunar year (*hawl*), legally right of the poor (**Q 51:19**) distributed to the **8 categories in** Qurʾan 9:60 **(***the destitute [fuqara'], needy [masakin], collectors, new hearts reconciled, freeing captives/slaves, debtors, in Allah's cause, stranded travellers***).**
  2. **Voluntary** *Sadaqah***:** Given anytime with no minimum threshold — even **half a date** protects from Hellfire [Bukhari], and **smiling, removing harm from a road, or a kind word is** *sadaqah*, letting poor Muslims give charity equally alongside billionaires!
  3. **Ongoing Charity (***Sadaqah Jariyah* **/** *Waqf* **Endowment):** Wells, hospitals, schools, Qurʾans whose reward keeps flowing into the grave after death [Muslim].
- **Inclusion of Everyone in** *Eid* **& Importance of** *Udhiyah* **Sacrifice (**1.7 **Bullet 3):**
  - *Eid ul-Fitr* **(1st** *Shawwal***):** Mandatory *Zakat ul-Fitr* (*Fitrana* — staple food/cash paid **before** *Eid* prayer for every man, woman, and child) specifically *"to enrich the poor from begging on the day of Eid"* [Abu Dawud]. Prophet instructed **even menstruating women** (exempt from ritual prayer itself) to attend the open-air *Eid musalla* for *duʾa*, *takbir*, community joy, and sermon!

  - *Eid ul-Adha* **(10th** *Dhul-Hijjah***) &** *Udhiyah / Qurbani***:** Recalls **Ibrahim & Isma'il's supreme submission** (**Q 37:102–107**). Note **Qur'an 22:37**: *"Neither their meat nor their blood reaches Allah; it is your piety (taqwa) that reaches Him."* Sunnah 3-way distribution: **1/3 immediate family**, **1/3 relatives, friends & neighbours**, **1/3 poor & destitute** — uniting non-pilgrims globally with *Hajj* pilgrims!
- **Intentions <-> Actions <-> Afterlife Triangle (**1.7 **Bullet 4):**
  - **Intention (***Niyyah***, Hadith 1)** gives spiritual validity -> **Righteous Actions (***Amal Salih***)** embody faith visibly in society -> **Judgment & Afterlife (***'Akhirah***, Mizan scale** Q 99:7–8**)** provides ultimate accountability where an atom's weight of sincere good or showy evil (*riya*) is unveiled.

[AO2 EVAL] 1.7 AO2 Evaluation Cheat-Sheet (15 Marks)

- **Agree (***Hajj / Zakat / Eid creates true equality & unity***):** Physical erasure of race/wealth in *Ihram* & *Muzdalifah*; universal *Qiblah*; mandatory *Zakat* & *Fitrana* redistribute wealth by Divine law rather than optional pity.
- **Counter (***Limits in practice vs other acts***):** *Hajj* costs thousands of dollars and strict quotas exclude 99% of poor Muslims most years; modern VIP luxury *Hajj* packages near the *Haram* re-introduce wealth tiers; people evade *Zakat*; **5 daily congregational** *Salah* **& annual** *Ramadan* unite rich and poor side-by-side 365 days a year in every village without a plane ticket!
- **Level 5 Conclusion:** *Hajj* is **unrivalled as an international once-in-a-lifetime symbol of global racial equality**, whereas **daily** *Salah*, *Ramadan*, **and honest** *Zakat* **are more decisive for sustained, everyday local social justice**.

> **[PRIORITY #1] SECTION B PREDICTION #2:** Unit 1.5 Purification and Intention **(*Wudu, Ghusl, Tayammum, Niyyah, Shahadah, Sawm & Zakat*)**

> [SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.5**):**
> *- the rituals of purification for prayer, preparation for pilgrimage (Hajj) and purification in Islamic birth and death rituals*
> *- purification of the mind from worldly thoughts and the importance of making the right intention (niyyah) and purification of the heart through the statement of faith (shahadah)*
> *- fasting in Ramadan (sawm) as a form of physical and spiritual renewal*
> *- almsgiving (zakat) as a means of purification of wealth.*

[AO1 NOTES] Complete AO1 Revision Notes (1.5)

- **Foundational Scriptural Quotes:**
  - **Hadith** [Muslim]: *"Purity is half of faith (*Al-tuhuru shatr al-iman*)."*
  - **Qurʾan 5:6**: **Commands washing face, hands/forearms to elbows, wiping head, and washing feet to ankles before prayer; commands** *ghusl* **if in major impurity; grants** *tayammum* **with clean earth if sick, travelling, or without water (***"Allah does not wish to place difficulty upon you, but wishes to purify you"***).**
  - **Qurʾan 2:222**: *"Truly Allah loves those who repent constantly and loves those who purify themselves."*
- **1. Outer Rituals of Purification for Prayer (***Taharah* **— NEVER TESTED YET!):**
  - **Pre-Conditions:** Removing physical impurity (*najasah* — blood, urine, alcohol, filth) from body, modest clothing (*awrah* covered), and prayer spot.
  - **Minor Ablution (***Wudu***) — Required after sleep, toilet, wind, etc.:**
  1. Silent **intention (***niyyah***)** in heart + saying *Bismillah*;
  2. Wash hands to wrists **3x**; rinse mouth (*madmadah*) **3x** & sniff/blow nose (*istinshaq*) **3x**;
  3. Wash entire **face** hairline-to-chin, ear-to-ear **3x** *(fard)*;
  4. Wash **right then left arm including elbows 3x** *(fard)*;
  5. Wipe wet hands over **head (***masah***) & ears 1x** *(fard)*;
  6. Wash **right then left foot including ankles 3x** *(fard)*, maintaining order (*tartib*) without wasting water (Prophet forbade wasting water even at a flowing river!).
  - **Spiritual meaning:** Hadith in **Muslim**: as water drips off the face, hands, and feet in *wudu*, **every minor sin committed by eyes, hands, and feet washes out with the last drop of water**, and *wudu* limbs shine bright white (*ghurran muhajjalin*) on Resurrection Day!
  - **Major Ablution (***Ghusl***):** Mandatory full-body wash after marital relations, wet dreams (*janabah*), menstruation (*hayd*), or childbirth bleeding (*nifas*) — *niyyah*, washing private parts, full *wudu*, pouring water over entire head & body **3x** ensuring no hair root stays dry; recommended on Fridays (*Jumuʿah*), *Eids*, entering *Ihram*, and upon a convert accepting Islam.
  - **Dry Ablution (***Tayammum***):** Performed with **clean earth/sand/stone** when water is absent or using water worsens illness/wound (**Q 5:6**): *niyyah* + strike clean dust lightly with palms, wipe **face** and **hands/wrists** -> proves purification is ultimately **spiritual obedience to Allah**, NOT mere soap-and-water hygiene!
  - *(Quick links across 1.5 bullet 1: Birth purity = circumcision* khitan*, shaving newborn hair + silver weight to poor on day 7, post-natal* ghusl*; Hajj prep = paying debts, seeking forgiveness from wronged people,* ghusl *& white* Ihram*; Death = washing deceased 3x/odd numbers with camphor before shrouding in white* kafan*).*
- **2. Inner Purification — Mind (***Khushuʿ***), Intention (***Niyyah***) & Heart (***Shahadah***):**

  - **Purifying the Mind:** Blocking worldly worries, phone/work distractions, and Satanic whispers (*waswasah*) to achieve *khushuʿ* **(humble mental focus & awe)** in prayer (**Qurʾan 23:1–2**: *"Successful indeed are the believers, those who humble themselves in their prayers"*) and standing as though seeing Allah (*Ihsan* — Hadith of Jibril).
  - **Right Intention (***Niyyah* **— Hadith 1):** Distinguishes worship from habit (*fasting vs dieting*, *wudu vs cooling off*), discriminates prayers (*Zuhr vs Asr*), elevates everyday halal work/feeding family into rewarded worship, and guards the heart against **ostentation (***riya* **= minor** *shirk***).**
  - **Purifying the Heart via** *Shahadah***:** *"La ilaha illa Allah, Muhammadur Rasulullah"* — sweeps away polytheism (*shirk*), superstition, ego, and fear of creation; for a new convert, sincere *Shahadah* **erases 100% of past sins** [Muslim].
- **3.** *Sawm* **Renewal &** *Zakat* **Wealth Purification:**
  - *Sawm* **(Ramadan):** Physically rests digestive habits & breaks addictions; spiritually burns sins (*"Whoever fasts Ramadan out of faith seeking reward has past sins forgiven"* — Bukhari), strengthens self-control (*taqwa*, **Q 2:183**), and awakens heart-empathy.
  - *Zakat* **(Literal meaning =** *"Purification & Growth"***):** Cleanses the giver's soul from greed/stinginess (**Qurʾan 9:103**: *"Take charity from their wealth to purify and sanctify them"*), cleanses remaining 97.5% wealth for blessing (*barakah*), and purifies poor hearts from envy/resentment.

[AO2 EVAL] 1.5 AO2 **Evaluation Cheat-Sheet (**15 Marks**)**

- **Outer (***Wudu/Ghusl***) vs Inner (***Niyyah/Khushuʿ/Shahadah***) Purity:**
  - **Why Outer Matters:** Strict legal precondition (*"No prayer is accepted without purification"* — Muslim; **Q 5:6**); physically wakes the mind, structures transition from marketplace to standing before the King.
  - **Why Inner Matters More Ultimately: Q 107:4–6** curses worshippers who perform physical prayer heedlessly purely to be seen (*riya*); **Tayammum** proves even dust suffices physically when intention obeys Allah; hypocrites made perfect *wudu* in Medina yet lacked *shahadah* sincerity in the heart (**Q 63:1**).
  - **Level 5 Conclusion:** Outer purification is the **non-negotiable legal key** validating ritual acts, whereas inner purification of mind and heart is **harder to sustain and determines true spiritual acceptance and Paradise**.

> **[PRIORITY #1] SECTION B PREDICTION #3:** Unit 1.6 Acts of Devotion and Commitment **(*Ashura, Duʾa, Family & Nikah, Prayers & Taqwa*)**

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.6**):**
- daily and occasional prayer rituals, including the five daily prayers, Eid prayers and prayers on special occasions
- the importance of acts of worship (ibadah) and developing God-consciousness (taqwa)
- the role of the family in developing faith; marriage (nikah) as an act of commitment
- diversity of acts of devotion carried out by different Muslims, including Ashura, the 10th of Muharram and personal prayers (duʾa) for guidance.

[AO1 NOTES] 1.6A Diversity of Devotion: *Ashura* (10th Muharram) & Personal *Duʾa* (NEVER TESTED IN 6 YEARS!)

1. *Ashura* **— The** 10th of Muharram **(CRITICAL: Always Give BOTH Sunni AND Shiʾi Perspectives!):**
   - **Sunni Muslim Perspective & Practice (Gratitude & Expiation Fast):**
     - **Origin:** When the Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) migrated to Medina (**622 CE**), he saw Jewish residents fasting on the 10th of *Muharram* in gratitude because **Allah saved Prophet Musa (Moses, pbuh) and Bani Israʾil from Pharaoh across the Red Sea**. The Prophet (pbuh) declared: *"We have closer claim to Musa than you"* [Bukhari & Muslim], fasted it, and encouraged Muslims to fast **both the 9th and 10th** (or 10th and 11th) to distinguish Muslim practice.
     - **Spiritual Benefit & Actions:** Before obligatory *Ramadan* (**2 AH**), *Ashura* was obligatory; afterward it became a beloved voluntary fast (*Sunnah*) that **expiates the minor sins of the entire preceding year** [Muslim], accompanied by extra charity (*sadaqah*), Qurʾan reflection, and generosity toward one's family.
   - **Shiʾi Muslim Perspective & Practice (Martyrdom of Imam Husayn at Karbala):**
     - **Origin:** On the **10th of Muharram** 61 AH / 680 CE **on the desert plain of** Karbala (Iraq)**, the Prophet's beloved grandson** Imam Husayn ibn ʿAli **(3rd Shiʾi Imam), alongside 72 family members and companions, refused to pledge allegiance to the corrupt tyranny of** Yazid ibn Muʿawiyah **and was brutally martyred while thirsty in defence of authentic Islam and justice.**
     - **Devotional Practices:** Solemn mourning and moral renewal (*Azadari*) across the first 10 days of Muharram: wearing black garments, gathering in *Majalis* to recite historical accounts and elegies (*Marsiya / Latmiyyah*), weeping out of love for *Ahl al-Bayt* (Prophet's household), pilgrimage (*Ziyarah*) to Karbala, blood donations, and setting up free public water and meal stations (*Sabil / Niyaz* — honouring the thirst of Husayn's children!). *(Note: Many major modern Shiʾi scholars forbid self-harming blades, channelling grief into blood donation and social justice instead.)*
     - **Shared Underlying Meaning:** Despite contrasting moods (*gratitude fast* vs *solemn mourning*), **both Sunni and Shiʾi commemorations celebrate truth standing firm against tyranny (Musa vs Pharaoh / Husayn vs Yazid)**!

2. **Personal Prayers (*Duʾa*) for Guidance vs Formal *Salah*:**
   - **Quotes: Qurʾan 40:60**: *"Call upon Me; I will respond to you."* | Qurʾan 2:186**:** *"When My servants ask thee concerning Me, I am indeed close..."* | **Hadith [Tirmidhi]:** *"Duʾa is the very essence of worship."*
   - **How *Duʾa* Differs from *Salah*:** *Salah* has fixed 5 daily times, *wudu*, facing *Qiblah*, fixed *rakʿahs*, and Arabic recitation; *Duʾa* can be whispered anytime (24/7), anywhere, in **any native language** (English, Creole, French, Arabic), with hands raised, in *sujud* (*"A servant is closest to his Lord in prostration"* — Muslim), at 3 AM, while travelling, or in crisis.
   - **Prayers Specifically for Guidance:** Repeating *Surah Al-Fatihah* **17 times daily** (*"Guide us to the Straight Path"*), **Prophet's** Hadith 75 **supplication**, and *Salat al-Istikharah* (2 optional *rakʿahs* + Prophetic *duʾa* asking Allah's knowledge & decree before marriage, career, or major life choices [Bukhari]).
   - **Diversity of Devotion Across Global Islam:** Also includes Sufi **remembrance (*dhikr*) circles**, nightly **Tarawih / Tahajjud**, **Qurʾan completion (*Khatm*)**, and **Salawat** on the Prophet (pbuh).

[AO1 NOTES] 1.6B Role of the Family in Developing Faith & Marriage (*Nikah*) as Commitment

- **How the Family Develops Faith (*First Madrasah*):**
  1. **Infancy (*Fitrah*):** Prophet (pbuh) taught *"Every child is born upon natural pure disposition (*fitrah*)"* [Bukhari]; parents whisper *Adhan* **&** *Iqamah* into newborn's ears so Allah's Name is the very first sound heard, perform *Tahnik* & *Aqiqah*, and give righteous names.
  2. **Childhood Modelling & Teaching:** Teaching prayer gently at age **7** and firmly at **10** [Abu Dawud]; modelling waking for *Suhur/Fajr*, fasting mini-days in Ramadan, giving coins in charity boxes, and echoing Luqman's wisdom (**Qurʾan 31:13–19**) & **Qurʾan 66:6** (*"Protect yourselves and your families from a Fire"*).
  3. **Lifelong Moral Anchor:** Mutual respect across generations (**Q 17:23–24**, **Hadith 316**), preserving identity especially when Muslims live as minorities in secular societies.
- **Marriage (*Nikah*) as a Sacred Act of Religious Commitment (Last seen:** M/J 2022 **— 4.5 yrs ago!):**
  - **Quotes: Qurʾan 30:21**: **Allah created spouses** *"that you may dwell in tranquillity (sakinah), and placed love (mawaddah) and mercy (rahmah) between you."* | Hadith [Bayhaqi]: *"When a servant marries, he has completed half his religion (din); let him fear Allah in the remaining half."*
  - **Essential Elements of Performing *Nikah*:**
  1. **Mutual Free Consent (*Ijab* offer & *Qabul* acceptance)** — forced marriage is invalid in Islam [Bukhari];
  2. **Guardian (*Wali*)** protecting bride's interests (with school nuances);

3. **At least Two Reliable Adult Witnesses** ensuring public accountability;
4. **Mandatory Dower (***Mahr***)** gifted exclusively by groom to bride (**Qurʾan 4:4** — her sole property);
5. **Marriage Contract (***Nikahnama***)** allowing fair conditions + **Marriage Sermon (***Khutbah al-Nikah***)** reading *taqwa* verses + **Public Wedding Feast (***Walimah***)** sharing food with rich AND poor [Bukhari].

– **Special Occasion Prayers Quick Checklist (**1.6 **Bullet 1):** Five daily prayers (*Fajr 2, Zuhr 4, Asr 4, Maghrib 3, Isha 4*), Friday *Jumuʿah* (obligatory congregational 2 *rakʿahs* preceded by two *khutbahs* — **Q 62:9**), *Eid* **prayers** (no *adhan/iqamah*, extra *takbirs*, *khutbah* **after** prayer), *Tarawih* (Ramadan nights), *Salat al-Janazah* (standing funeral prayer of 4 *takbirs* & *duʾa*, zero *rukuʿ/sujud*), *Kusuf/Khusuf* (solar/lunar eclipse prayer), *Istisqaʾ* (rain prayer).

[AO2 EVAL] 1.6 AO2 Evaluation Cheat-Sheet (15 Marks)

- **Family vs Wider Community (***Ummah***):** Family shapes earliest *fitrah* and daily habits 24/7, **HOWEVER** reverts to Islam, youth in non-practising/abusive homes, or Prophet Ibrahim himself (whose father Azar carved idols!) rely completely on **mosques, *Jumuʿah*, scholars, righteous friends, and global** *ummah* to sustain faith.
- **Diversity of Devotion (Strength vs Division?):** Different practices (*Ashura* mourning vs fasting, *dhikr*, *Mawlid*) enrich emotional connection across cultures while united on **1 Qurʾan, 5 Pillars, &** *Tawhid*, though sectarian hostility contradicts **Qurʾan 3:103** (*"Hold fast altogether to the Rope of Allah and be not divided"*).

[HIGH PRIORITY] SECTION B PREDICTION #4: Unit 1.4 Main Beliefs **(*Angels, Tawhid, Books, Prophets & Linking Beliefs to Pillars*)**

[SYLLABUS] **Official Syllabus Specification (**1.4**):**
- belief in a single Creator God (tawhid)
- the role of prophets as human messengers, delivering revelations (risalah)
- angels as deliverers of books and recorders of human actions (malaikah)
- the revealed word of God as guidance to humankind (wahy)
- the Day of Judgement and the afterlife (ʾakhirah) | (Note: qadar just appeared in M/J 2026!)
- **Key Syllabus Skill:** *consider how the main beliefs are strengthened and realised through a Muslim's actions, making explicit reference to the Five Pillars of Islam.*

[AO1 NOTES] Complete AO1 Revision Notes (1.4 — Focused on Overdue *Angels*, *Tawhid* & *Beliefs-to-Pillars Link*)

1. **Angels (*Malaikah*) — Second Article of Faith (**Last asked: O/N 2022 **— 4 yrs ago!):**
   - **Nature:** Created by Allah from **pure light (*nur*)** [Muslim]; invisible wing-bearing beings (**Qurʾan 35:1** — 2, 3, 4+ wings; Jibril seen with 600 wings covering horizon); **neither male nor female** (refuting Meccan claim they were "Allah's daughters"), **neither eat, drink, sleep, nor tire**; **possess NO free will to sin** (**Qurʾan 66:6**: *"They disobey not Allah in what He commands them, and do precisely what they are commanded"*).
   - **Exact Named Angels & Their Duties (Memorise All 7!):**
     1. *Jibril* **(Gabriel —** *Ruh al-Qudus***):** Archangel of Revelation — brought all Divine Scriptures, including the **Qurʾan** to Muhammad (pbuh) over **23 years** (**Q 2:97**), taught him *wudu* and the 5 prayer times, accompanied him on *Miʿraj*, and descends on *Laylat al-Qadr* (**Q 97:4**).
     2. *Mikaʾil* **(Michael):** Governs **rain, winds, crop growth, and physical sustenance (*rizq*)** across earth.
     3. *Israfil***:** Blows the **Trumpet (*As-Sur*) twice** — first blast ends earthly life, second blast raises all souls for Resurrection (**Qurʾan 39:68**).
     4. *Malak al-Mawt* **(Angel of Death —** Q 32:11**):** Extracts souls at the appointed instant of death (gently for believers, sternly for wicked).
     5. *Kiraman Katibeen* **(Noble Recorders —** Q 82:10–12**,** Q 50:17–18**):** Two angels seated at every person's right and left shoulders — right records every good deed & intention immediately (multiplied 10x–700x); left records sins (pausing softly in case the believer repents!).
     6. *Munkar* **&** *Nakir***:** Question every soul in the grave (*Barzakh*): *"Who is your Lord? What is your religion? Who is this Prophet?"*
     7. **Guardian Angels (***Muʿaqqibat* **—** Q 13:11**),** *Ridwan* **(Paradise gatekeeper),** *Malik* **& 19** *Zabaniyah* **(Hellfire keepers —** Q 43:77**), & Mosque/Dhikr Angels:** Surround Qurʾan circles, record early Friday *Jumuʿah* arrivals, and say *"Ameen"* during *Salah* (**Al-Fatihah**) and when praying for an absent brother!
   - **How Belief in Angels Directly Shapes Daily Actions & Pillars:**
     - **Kiraman Katibeen -> Moral Integrity in Private:** Restrains secret cheating, online sin, lying, or *riba* even behind locked doors; inspires hidden *sadaqah*.
     - **Jibril -> Reverence for Qurʾan &** *Salah***:** Guards every word of Qurʾan as direct Heavenly speech; observe *Ramadan Laylat al-Qadr* eagerly (**Q 97:4**).
     - **Salah & Jumuʿah Angels -> Punctuality & Focus:** Arriving early Friday before angels close the scroll [Bukhari]; greeting right and left shoulders with *As-salamu ʿalaykum wa rahmatullah* at end of *Salah*!
     - **Guardian Angels -> Courage & Comfort:** Removes loneliness and fear.

2. **Belief in One Creator God (*Tawhid*) — First Article of Faith (**Last asked: M/J 2022 **— 4.5 yrs ago!):**
   - **Three Interlocking Dimensions of *Tawhid*:**
     1. *Tawhid al-Rububiyyah* **(Oneness of Lordship):** Allah alone created the universe *ex nihilo*, sustains every atom, gives life and death (**Q 13:3–4**, **Q 1:2** *Rabb al-ʿAlamin*).
     2. *Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah* **(Oneness of Worship): Allah ALONE deserves prayer, fasting, vows, sacrifice, and ultimate devotion** (**Q 1:5** *"You alone we worship and You alone we ask for help"*).
     3. *Tawhid al-Asma wa-Sifat* **(Oneness of Names & Attributes):** 99 Beautiful Names (*Al-Asma al-Husna*) uniquely belong to Allah without human flaw or likeness (**Qurʾan 42:11**: *"There is nothing whatever like unto Him"*).
   - **Two Essential Qurʾanic Proof Passages:**
     - **Surah Al-Ikhlas (112:1–4)** *(equals 1/3 of Qurʾan!)*: *"He is Allah, the One and Only (*Ahad*); Allah, the Eternal, Absolute (*As-Samad*); He begetteth not, nor is He begotten; And there is none like unto Him."*
     - **Ayat al-Kursi (2:255)**: **Ever-Living (*Al-Hayy*), Self-Subsisting (*Al-Qayyum*), untouched by slumber or sleep, all-encompassing Knowledge and Throne.**
   - **Opposite Sin — *Shirk*:** Major *shirk* (idolatry, praying to saints/graves/stars) is **the single unrepented sin Allah will never forgive (**Qurʾan 4:116**)**; minor *shirk* = **showing off (*riya*)** in deeds.
3. **Master Link Table — How ALL 6 Main Beliefs Are Realised Through the 5 Pillars (**1.4 **Explicit Syllabus Requirement!):**

Five Pillar Action	How Inner Main Beliefs (1.4) Are Expressed & Strengthened
1. *Shahadah*	Proclaims *Tawhid* (One God) + *Risalah* (Muhammad as final Messenger, accepting all Books, Angels, *ʾAkhirah*, *Qadar*).
2. *Salah* **(5x Daily)**	Physical submission (*sujud*) to *Tawhid*; recites *Wahy* (*Qurʾan*); declares **Q 1:4** *"Master of the Day of Judgment"* (*ʾAkhirah*); greets **Angels** at *taslim*; invokes blessings (*Salawat*) on **Prophets** Ibrahim & Muhammad.
3. *Zakat* **(2.5%)**	Proves wealth belongs to Allah (*Rabb* / *Tawhid*), tests stewardship (*Qadar*), recorded by *Kiraman Katibeen* for heavy scales on Judgment Day (*ʾAkhirah*).
4. *Sawm* **(Ramadan)**	Celebrates revelation of *Qurʾan (Wahy)* via **Jibril** (**Q 2:185**); purest secret obedience to All-Seeing God (*Tawhid* — Hadith Qudsi *"Fasting is for Me"*).
5. *Hajj* **(Mecca)**	Traces footsteps of **Prophets** Ibrahim, Ismaʾil & Muhammad (*Risalah*); white *Ihram* & standing on *ʿArafat* rehearse **Resurrection & Judgment (***ʾAkhirah***)** around the House of **One God (***Tawhid***).**

[AO2 EVAL] 1.4 AO2 Evaluation Cheat-Sheet (15 Marks)

- **"Beliefs in the heart matter far more than outward actions"** OR **"Tawhid is the only belief a Muslim needs":**
  - **Agree:** Without sincere inner *iman* and *tawhid*, mountains of outward ritual are rejected as empty hypocrisy (**Q 4:116**, **Q 24:39** deeds like a desert mirage, **Hadith 1**); an elderly/paralyzed person or deathbed convert enters *Jannah* on pure heart-faith alone (*"Whoever says La ilaha illa Allah sincerely enters Jannah"*).
  - **Disagree:** Across 50+ Qurʾanic verses, Allah inseparably binds *"those who believe AND work righteous deeds"* (**Qurʾan 103:1–3** *Surah Al-ʿAsr* — everyone is in loss EXCEPT those with faith **AND** righteous deeds!). Rejecting any single Article of Faith (e.g. denying Angels, Prophets, or Resurrection) destroys *Tawhid* itself because Allah's Qurʾan commands all six (**Qurʾan 4:136**).
  - **Level 5 Conclusion:** Inner *iman* centred on *Tawhid* is the **root and soul** without which actions die, while the Five Pillars and moral deeds are the **trunk and fruit** that keep inner faith alive and authentic—neither is complete in normal life without the other.